



Rajat Moona with wife Rajni and son Pratik

With all the accolades and responsibilities, Prof. Moona continues to preach humility in front of all—peers, superiors, and subordinates. “My teachers—my grandfather, my friend Prof. Pawan Kumar, and Prof. V Rajaraman—all were geniuses in their respective fields, but what I truly admire about them is their humility. In academia you come across all kinds of people, yet these three not only excelled as

educators, but they also embodied important humanistic values. These values had a significant impact on me as well,” he declares.

He went on to work on many interesting projects while at CDAC. “We worked on developing a national electoral search for Indian voters, which could search one using phonetic search methods out of about 850 million voter records within a blink of an eye. I could

also implement postal e-ballot for a class of Indian voters,” he exclaims, bubbling with childlike wonder, still in awe of the fact that he got to be a part of these projects and contribute to his country. “M3 EVMs and VVPATs are security beauties. I had a fulfilling experience designing them!” he continues.

His association with IISc took a new turn when CDAC came up with an opportunity to contribute to the National Supercomputing Mission. From a scientific officer working to build a supercomputer for his doctoral thesis to becoming an active contributor and developer of National Supercomputing Mission along with IISc, all through his journey Prof. Moona was guided by his will to share knowledge and bring it to everyone.

“I fully conceptualised and implemented a CDAC product called PARAM Shavak. The idea was to commoditise supercomputing and bring it to the reach of researchers. It is a low-cost but powerful supercomputing solution that can fit in a small lab and can empower small research groups with large computing,” he explains.

Prof. Moona’s life was nurtured by academicians and learned humans who went above and beyond to help and share their knowledge with whoever came to them. Imbibing these qualities, Prof. Moona is known for being a strict and fair professor in class. Outside the classroom, he is known for being a support system for all his students. He believes, “Helping people is not about doing favours or finding them jobs. It’s about empowering them so they can move forward on their own.”

## Trudging ahead

While the world knows him as an academician and brainiac, Prof. Moona is an avid trekker